

Philipp Hilbert. *Senior Product Manager, Identity & Trust Infrastructure.*

Positioning, fintech-native PM with 13 years shipping regulated B2B platforms, from payments to defence AI, ready to own the roadmap at Clera from day one.

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Dear Clera team,

Identity and trust infrastructure is not a feature category: it is load-bearing product. Businesses adopt it once and depend on it indefinitely, which means every roadmap decision carries architectural weight far beyond its sprint size. That asymmetry is exactly the kind of problem I have spent my career learning to reason about carefully.

My most directly relevant context is Kvitt Payment Solutions, a fintech B2B payments product I co-founded, took through the Sparkasse integration, and exited into the girocard ecosystem. Before a payment can move, both parties have to trust the rail: I built the verification and consent flows from scratch and watched which edge cases broke trust fastest. More recently at EMIL Group I owned the B2B SaaS platform serving insurers, reinsurers and brokers, which is structurally similar to identity infrastructure: multi-sided, high compliance overhead, and deeply sensitive to downtime. I restructured a struggling 18-person delivery organisation, shipped the Claims Center from zero to production, and cut insurance-product time-to-market from months to under a week.

What I bring to Clera specifically is the combination of platform product experience and the operational discipline to run a distributed team without losing alignment. At Rohde & Schwarz I managed 15+ engineers and data scientists across multinational time zones on the internal AI and data platform for the FCAS programme. I introduced GitOps delivery with ArgoCD that cut rollout time from days to 30 minutes and made the platform hotfix-capable in a regulated, high-stakes environment. At the Bundesagentur für Arbeit I owned the national labour-market analytics platform as Deputy IT Security Officer, carrying a full containerisation migration and a large ETL overhaul simultaneously. Both roles required the clear, documented decision-making the posting calls out: in distributed teams, undocumented decisions are broken decisions.

The seed-stage context matters to me. I have founded four companies, which means I know what it feels like to own a roadmap that is still being discovered rather than maintained. The constraint of a small team sharpens prioritisation: I default to the cheapest experiment that resolves the highest-risk assumption, and I keep outcome metrics agreed before a feature ships rather than retrofitted afterwards.

I am based in Berlin, work fully within EU time zones, and can start within four weeks of an offer. I would be glad to talk through how my background maps to the specific problems Clera is working on right now.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
